

CHAPTER 08

CULTURE OF PAKISTAN



CHARACTERISTICS OF CULTURE

Culture encompasses the beliefs, practices, arts, laws, customs, and habits of a particular group of people. It is the invisible bond that ties people of a community together, represented through their way of life, religious practices, social customs, and dietary habits. Culture is passed down from generation to generation, constantly evolving and adapting to changes in society.. There are following characteristics of culture:

- A culture which has positive a force influences the other culture.
- New culture might emerge on contact with other culture.
- The individual identity of culture makes it popular among others.
- The culture with strong and permanent values absorbs the weak cultures.
- The Islamic culture prevailed in the past because the Muslim followed their religion and its great value

LANGUAGE AS A CULTURAL CORNERSTONE

Language is a fundamental element of culture because it is the primary means of communication. It conveys the knowledge, beliefs, and traditions of a community. Language not only allows individuals to share their thoughts and feelings but also helps in preserving cultural heritage and wisdom. More than 30 languages are being spoken in Pakistan major provisional languages are SINDHI, BALOCHI, PASHTO, PUNJABI & BRAHVI.

LANGUAGES OF PAKISTAN

There are more than 30 languages are spoken in Pakistan. The major provincial languages of our country include Sindhi, Punjabi, Balochi and Brahvi these languages represent their respective provinces are known as provincial languages.

1) URDU

The Aryans spoke Sanskrit Urdu derived from Sanskrit. Sanskrit changes under the influence of people living in south Asia and came to be known as Prakrit. With the passage of time Prakrit took four from. One of them was called brijbhasha which the Hindus and Muslims spoke. Brij bhasha changes so much during Shah Jahan's rule that it became a new language called to be Urdu.

2) SINDHI

Sindhi is one of the oldest south Asian languages. With the arrival of the Muslims the Sindhi language started taking strides and several Arabic Persian and Turkish words entered this language Sindhi is written in modified Arabic script Sindhi language has the distinction of being the first local language in which the Holy Quran was translated during the Muslim rule.

3) PUNJABI

The Language of the Punjab province is "Punjabi". The Punjabi vocabulary includes words from Arabic, Turkish and Persian languages although there are minor differences of dialect in the Punjabi spoken in different part of Punjabi.

4) BALOCHI

The Language of the Balochi tribes of Baluchistan is Balochi. Besides, BalochiPashto, Brahvi and Sindhi language are also spoken in this province. Balochi is linked with the ancient languages that were spoken in the southern and Eastern Iran. The Baloch tribes came from north eastern Iran and settled in that region of south Asia which is now called Balochistan. They brought with them the ancient Balochi Language.

LANGUAGE AS A CULTURAL CORNERSTONE**1) SOURCE OF CONTACT**

Urdu is spoken in all the four provinces of Pakistan. It is the source of national unity, solidarity and stability

2) ROLE IN PAKISTAN MOVEMENT

In Pakistan movement Urdu was the most favored language.

3) MEDIA COMMUNICATION

Urdu creating harmony among the people through television and radio.

4) INTERNATIONAL LANGUAGE

it is understood by a lot of people outside Pakistan too.

5) COMMON MEDIUM

it is common medium for people to talk and get education.

6) COORDINATION

Urdu serves as the medium of coordination between different provinces

CULTURAL MANIFESTATIONS IN NATIONAL LIFE

The common cultural manifestations in Pakistan's national life are observed in the daily routines, such as the respect for elders, hospitality to guests, and religious observances. Cultural expressions are also evident in traditional dress codes, cuisine, and participation in local and national events.

The people of Pakistan in a fraternal relation. The following cultural manifestation is common in the national life.

1. MIXED CULTURE

People from different regions having different cultures are settled in Pakistan. With the passage of time mixed culture is emerging now.

2. STATUS OF MEN AND WOMEN

Men are the head of family and women are the head of home. The rights and duties of men and women are determined in our religion.

3. SOCIAL LIFE

Joint family system is common in Pakistan. Men earn the livelihood and women take care of the children at home.

4. FOOD

Wheat, rice, meat vegetables, pulses. Eating habits are also common.

5. ENTERTAINMENTS

Our entertainments are also common like Cricket, Hockey, and Football. Beside people watch T.V and Radio.

6. RELIGIOUS EVENTS

We have religious events; e.g. Eid-ul-Fitar, Eid-ul-Adha. Besides, the occasion of birth and deaths are similar.

7. MEDIA OF COMMUNICATION

Radio, T.V, Newspaper, Magazines and means of transport all are playing their part in developing common nation culture.

8. SINGLE MESSAGE OF LOVE AND BROTHERHOOD

All the writers convey the message of higher aims of life to people so that there is Love, Peace, harmony, brotherhood, justice, tolerance and humanity among them.

LANGUAGE AS A CULTURAL CORNERSTONE

The arts and crafts of Pakistan reflect its aesthetic heritage. Skilled artisans produce a variety of handicrafts, including pottery, jewelry, embroidery, and carpets. These items are not only utilitarian but are also imbued with regional artistic traditions and are celebrated both nationally and internationally

CELEBRATING CULTURE THROUGH FESTIVALS

Many festivals are held in Pakistan every year. These occasions provide entertainment and joy to the people of Pakistan.

(1) EID-UL-FITR

It is celebrated after the month of Ramadan ends and on the first of Shawwal. This is a reward in the form of blessings of Allah to those Muslims who fasted for the whole month of Ramadan. People wear good dresses eat vermicelli's and exchange gifts poor people are helped in cash and kind by the rich

(2) EID-UL-AZHA

It is celebrated on the 10th of the month of Zil-Hajj in the memory of the great sacrifice of Hazrat Ibrahim when he offered to sacrifice the life of his dearest son Hazrat Ismail to fulfill the decree of Almighty Allah on Eid-ul-Azha people sacrifice animals and distribute meat among their relatives, friends, neighbors and the poor. The sacrifices is offered for three days i.e. 10th 11th and 12th Zil-hajj

(3) EID MILAD-UN-NABI

It is celebrated on 12th of the Islamic month of Rib-ul-Awwal with great love and devotion. It is celebrated to express happiness on the birth of our Holy Prophet. Hazrat Muhammad (S.A.W.S) Homes, streets and bazaars are decorated and illuminated Religious meetings are held it is celebrated with great devotion and zeal.